RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:49 PM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 368 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 44 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,810 minutes at 5:00 PM; Dammam moving with 3 takeoffs and no landings in the last hour

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,810 minutes at 5:00 PM; closure NOTAM lapsed at 12:00 AM but GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 368 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (64% of scheduled).
- Civil Defense sounded an early warning in Najran at 4:30 PM and gave the all-clear at 4:34 PM; no interception or damage reported.
- Interior Ministry warns that filming or sharing interceptions and impact sites can bring legal action (4:34 PM).
- Dammam airport moving with no halt open: 3 takeoffs in the last hour, latest flynas XY405 to Jeddah at 4:29 PM, but no landing since 3:29 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9860 min).

368	0/0	3
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

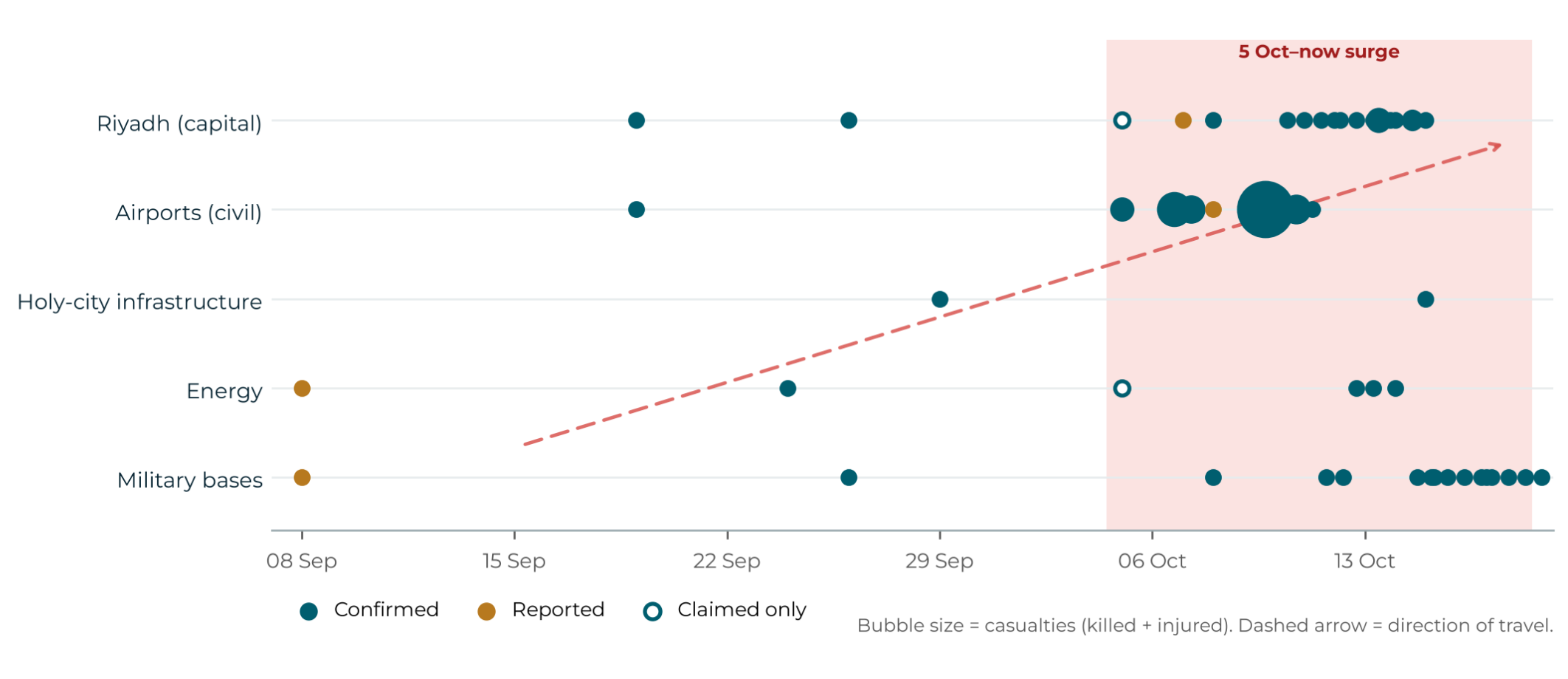
0 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

44	0/2	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (9,810 min at 5:00 PM); no GACA reopening announcement
- Civil Defense early warning in Najran at 4:30 PM, all-clear at 4:34 PM (@SaudiDCD)
- Interior Ministry, via Civil Defense, warns against filming or sharing interceptions and impact sites (4:34 PM)
- Deputy foreign minister met the US charge d'affaires and Arab ambassadors (4:23 and 4:30 PM, SPA)
- Dammam: 3 takeoffs (SV1115, F3310, XY405) and no landings in the last hour; latest landing XY731 at 3:29 PM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 5:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED ALERT **5:24 PM AST · US Mission security alert: follow Saudi Civil Defense cellular alerts; staff travel needs special authorization**

follow Saudi Civil Defense cellular alerts; staff travel needs special authorization: US Mission security alert: follow Saudi Civil Defense cellular alerts; staff travel needs special authorization. U.S. Embassy Riyadh

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 4, alerts 8, all-clears 7, casualty reports 1.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh airport still halted; Najran early warning and all-clear; Interior Ministry warns against filming interceptions

Checked at 5:52 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CORROBORATED **Indian Embassy advisory: Riyadh airport remains closed; Air India, Air India Express and IndiGo suspend Saudi flights until 24 Oct**

United News of India (@uniindianews) · **5:46 PM** · published 5:46 PM AST Sun 18 Oct; checked 5:52 PM

UNI reports the Embassy of India in Riyadh issued a safety advisory for Indian nationals, saying Riyadh airport remains closed while Dammam, Jeddah and Madinah airports face disruptions, and that Air India, Air India Express and IndiGo have suspended flights until 24 October.

CONFIRMED **Bahrain's foreign minister: the GCC stands as one with the Kingdom and welcomes the UN Security Council statement**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:34 PM** · published 5:34 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 5:52 PM

Speaking after the GCC-Russia meeting, Bahrain's foreign minister said the GCC stands united with Saudi Arabia, welcomed the Security Council statement condemning the continued Houthi attacks and affirming the Kingdom's right to self-defence under international law, and thanked Russia for backing the council's freedom-of-navigation resolution.

CONFIRMED **Saudi foreign minister meets his Russian counterpart in Manama on the Yemen escalation and threats to navigation**

Saudi Press Agency (@SPAregions, @Spa_Eng) · **5:31 PM** · published 5:31 PM AST (Arabic), 5:46 PM (English) Sun 18 Oct; checked 5:52 PM

On the sidelines of the GCC-Russia strategic dialogue in Manama, Prince Faisal bin Farhan met the Russian foreign minister to discuss regional developments, led by the escalation in Yemen and continued threats to navigation. He also took part in the 168th GCC Ministerial Council.

UNVERIFIED **Wrestling news sites say Riyadh airport 'reportedly reopened'; the board and GACA show no reopening**

Ringside News, Wrestling Central News (X posts) · **5:29 PM** · posts 5:29-5:45 PM AST; contradicted by Flightradar24 board and by UNI/Indian Embassy (5:46 PM, 'remains closed'); checked 5:52 PM

Several wrestling outlets, writing about WWE Crown Jewel, said King Khalid International Airport reportedly reopened on Sunday. No official source confirms this, the Flightradar24 board shows no takeoffs or landings, and a UNI report on an Indian Embassy advisory at 5:46 PM says the airport remains closed.

CONFIRMED **US Mission security alert: follow Saudi Civil Defense cellular alerts; staff travel needs special authorization**

U.S. Embassy Riyadh (@USAinKSA) · **5:24 PM** · published 5:24 PM AST Sun 18 Oct; checked 5:52 PM

The US Mission reminded American citizens to follow Saudi Civil Defense national alerts sent by cellular broadcast and said US government employees in Saudi Arabia need special authorization for some travel.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense early-warning alert in Najran, all-clear four minutes later**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD); Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:34 PM** · alert published 4:30 PM, all-clear 4:34 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 4:54 PM

The National Early Warning Platform issued an alert for Najran Province at 4:30 PM to warn of a potential danger, and Civil Defense said the danger had passed at 4:34 PM. It was Najran's second alert of the afternoon after the 1:37 PM one. No interception, debris or casualties were reported.

CONFIRMED **Interior Ministry warns that filming or sharing interceptions and impact sites can bring legal action**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD), citing the Ministry of Interior · **4:34 PM** · published 4:34 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic and English); checked 4:54 PM; Civil Defense re-posted the warning in Arabic, English and five other languages at 4:59-5:04 PM

Civil Defense repeated the Interior Ministry's warning that filming, publishing or sharing information about missile and drone interceptions and where debris falls exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED **Deputy foreign minister meets the US charge d'affaires, then Arab ambassadors, on regional developments**

Saudi Press Agency (@SPAregions) · **4:30 PM** · published 4:23 PM and 4:30 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 4:54 PM

Saudi Arabia's deputy foreign minister received the charge d'affaires of the US embassy to discuss regional and international developments, and then held a meeting with the Arab ambassadors accredited to the Kingdom. SPA did not publish details of what was said.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: coalition warplanes hit Houthi launch sites near Marib in Yemen**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:25 PM** · published 4:25 PM and 4:41 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official outlet's correspondent in Marib, translated from Arabic); checked 4:54 PM

Al Ekhbariya's correspondent said fighting is escalating around Marib, with warplanes hitting Houthi missile launch platforms in the Sirwah area and on the edge of Majzar district, and Houthi vehicles heading from Sanaa toward the northern Marib fronts. He added that Marib and displacement camps were hit by more than 16 missiles and shells in recent days.

CONFIRMED **Jordan and the GCC Secretary-General offer condolences over the Najran helicopter crash**

Saudi Press Agency (@SPAregions, @Spa_Eng) · **4:24 PM** · Jordan published 3:47 PM, GCC Secretary-General 4:24 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (SPA official accounts); checked 4:54 PM

Jordan expressed its condolences to Saudi Arabia over the two officers killed when a National Guard helicopter crashed in Najran, SPA reported.

CONFIRMED **GCC and GCC-Russia meetings in Manama renew condemnation of attacks on airports and energy facilities**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:34 PM** · published 3:34 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 3:52 PM

Al Ekhbariya's correspondent said the 168th GCC ministerial council and the ninth GCC-Russia strategic dialogue, both held in Manama, renewed their condemnation of the targeting of airports and energy facilities and affirmed the council's full solidarity with the Kingdom.

CONFIRMED **GCC Secretary-General condemns Houthi attacks targeting King Khalid International Airport and civilian sites, pledges full solidarity with the Kingdom**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv); Saudi Press Agency (@SPAregions) · **2:23 PM** · published 2:23 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account), repeating his 12:02 PM statement; at 2:32 PM he also offered condolences for the two officers killed in the Najran helicopter crash (SPA); checked 2:52 PM

GCC Secretary-General Jasem Albudaiwi, speaking at the GCC meeting, condemned the Houthi attacks that targeted King Khalid International Airport and civilian facilities in the Kingdom and said the Gulf states stand with Saudi Arabia and back every measure it takes to protect its security. He also said Iran's disruption of shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and its proxies' threats in Bab el-Mandeb and the Red Sea break international rules and threaten energy and food supplies, and called for Hormuz shipping to return to normal.

UNVERIFIED **Single social account reports explosions at the As Sulayyil missile base; no official confirmation**

WorldConflict_X (@WorldConflict_X) · **1:49 PM** · posted 1:49 PM AST Sun 18 Oct, citing unverified reports; checked 1:55 PM

A conflict-news account on X says explosions were reported inside the Saudi strategic missile base at As Sulayyil, citing unverified reports. No official source has confirmed it; Civil Defense declared the danger over in As Sulayyil at 1:41 PM.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense early-warning alerts in Najran and As Sulayyil, then all-clears within minutes**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **1:41 PM** · alerts published 1:37 PM (Najran) and 1:38 PM (As Sulayyil), all-clears 1:39 PM and 1:41 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account); also Al Ekhbariya and Arab News; checked 1:55 PM

The National Early Warning Platform issued danger alerts for Najran City at 1:37 PM and As Sulayyil Governorate at 1:38 PM. Civil Defense said the danger had passed in Najran at 1:39 PM and in As Sulayyil at 1:41 PM. No interception, debris or casualties have been officially reported.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9860 min).

368	—	—	0	3
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
194 departures + 174 arrivals, 64% of 578 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:49 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 370 at 5:50 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**194**	**174**	**368**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**195 (64%)**	**175 (64%)**	**370**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**1 (0%)**	**1**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**2 (100%)**	**0 (0%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 226**	**0 of 173**	**0 of 399**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**3**	**3**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**20**	**39**	**59**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**18**	**23**	**41**	FR24 stats panel

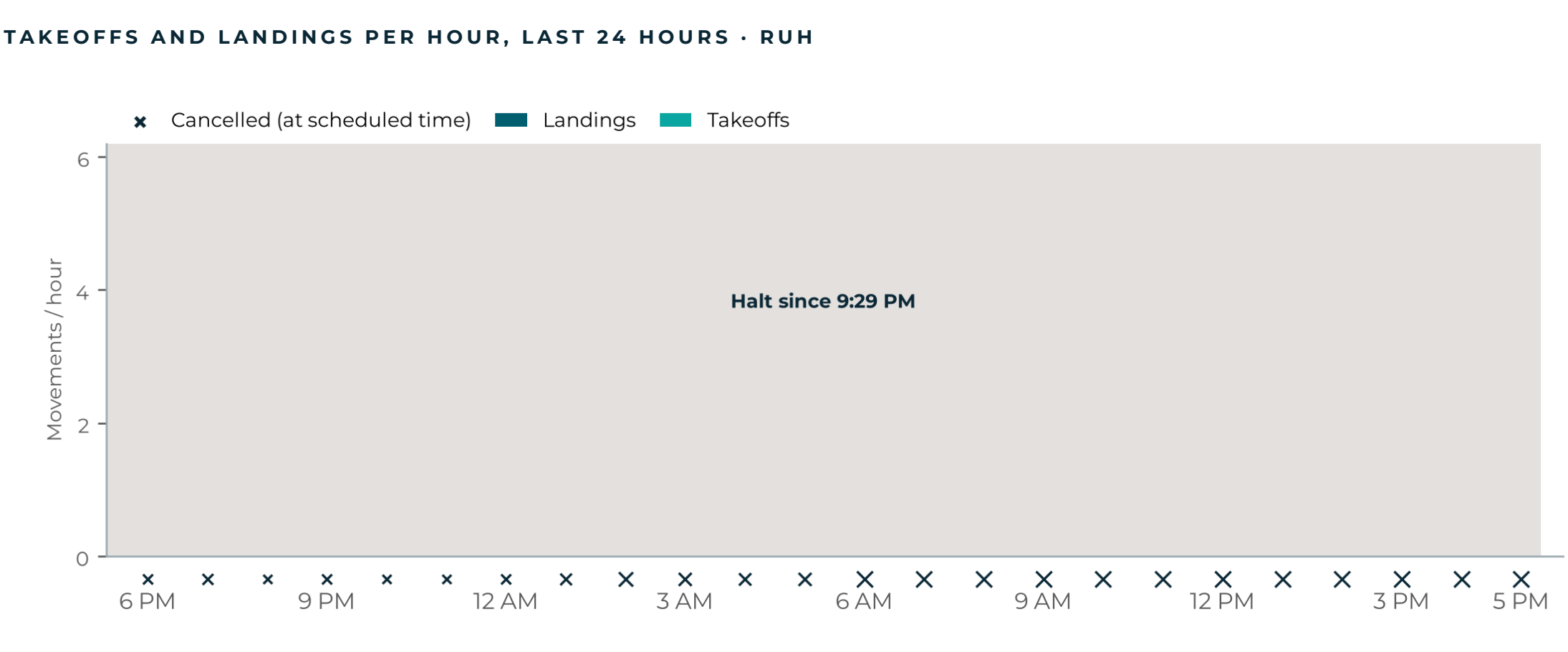
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	221
flynas	73
flyadeal	24
Qatar Airways	13
Riyadh Air	8

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	113
Madinah	31
Dubai	24
Dammam	22
Doha	15

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



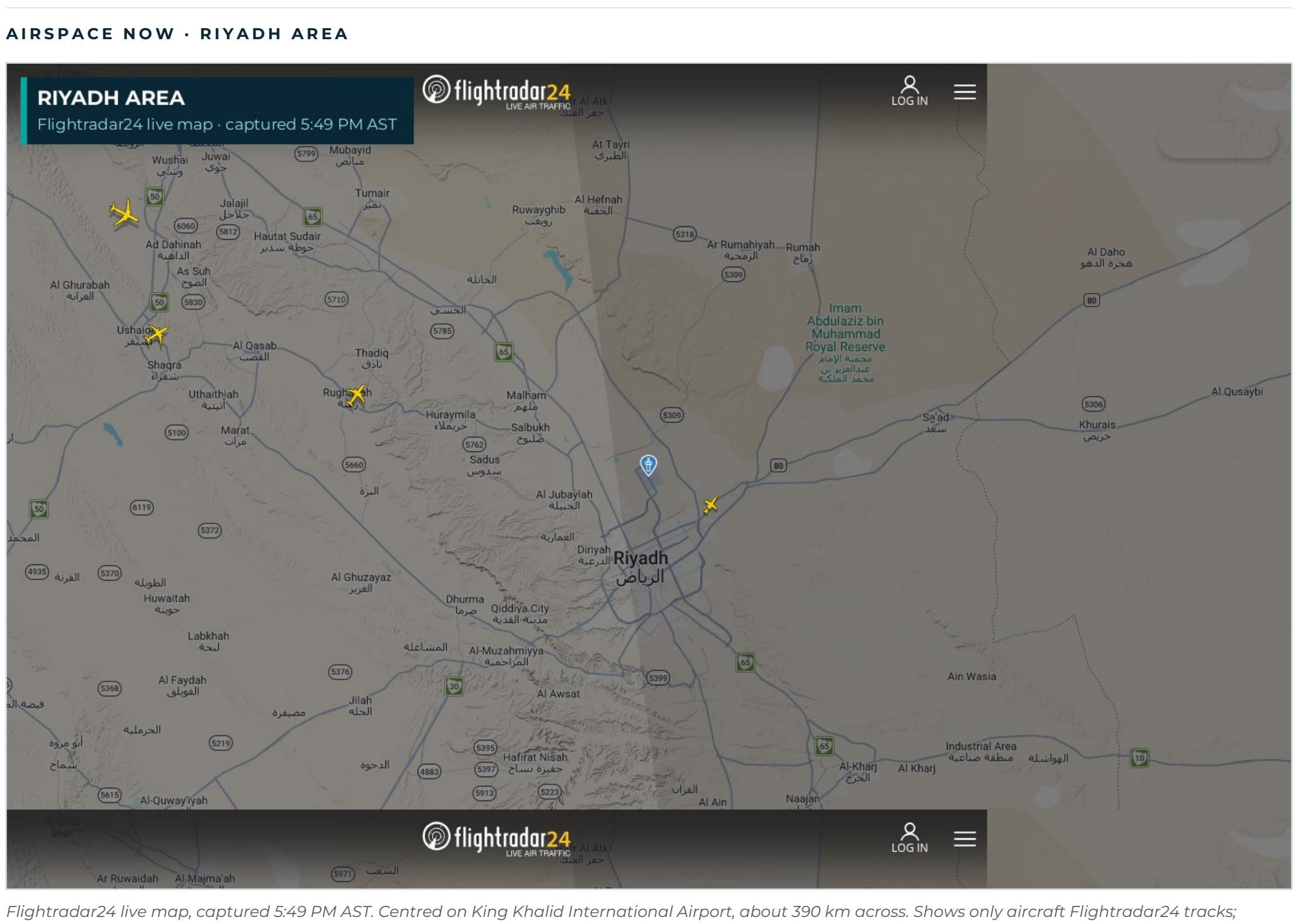
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 6:00 PM Saturday to 5:49 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's latest halt ran from 10:49 to 11:35 AM; takeoffs restarted with Gulf Air GF104 to Bahrain at 11:58 AM. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM, 1:15–2:04 AM, 2:49–4:29 AM and 8:17–9:18 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	9860 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA


RIYADH AREA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 5:49 PM AST

Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:49 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 0 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

44	4:29 PM	5:14 PM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
22 departures + 22 arrivals, 20% of 217 scheduled.	XY405 to Jeddah, 80 min before 5:49 PM.	G9167 from Sharjah, 35 min before 5:49 PM.	2 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:49 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 44 at 5:50 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**22**	**22**	**44**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**22 (20%)**	**22 (20%)**	**44**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**23 (21%)**	**17 (15%)**	**40**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**20 (47%)**	**26 (60%)**	**46**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**12 min**	**5 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**37 of 77**	**39 of 76**	**76 of 153**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**3**	**5**	**8**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**15**	**14**	**29**	FR24 stats panel

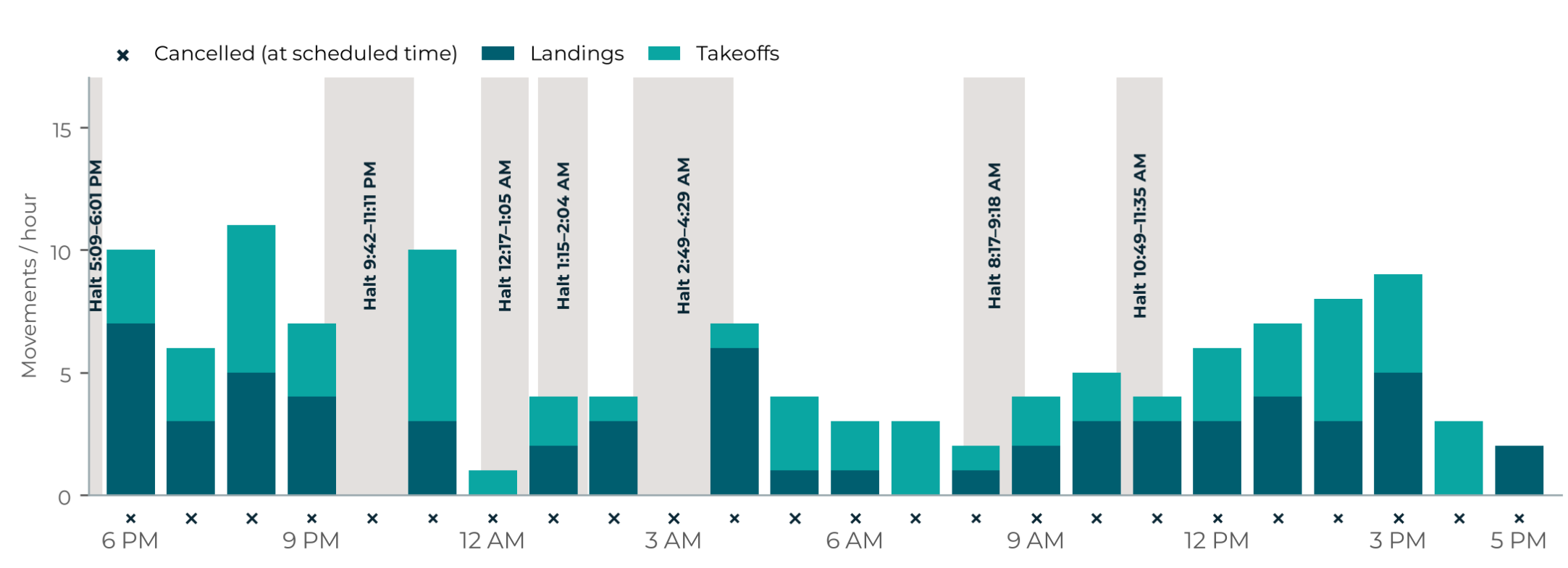
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	22
Egyptair	6
Qatar Airways	6
flyadeal	3
Turkish Airlines	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	22
Cairo	6
Doha	6
Istanbul	3
Amman	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (59) and landings (61) at DMM per hour from 6:00 PM Saturday to 5:49 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 3 takeoffs and no landings in the last hour. Latest halt 10:49 to 11:35 AM (46 min).

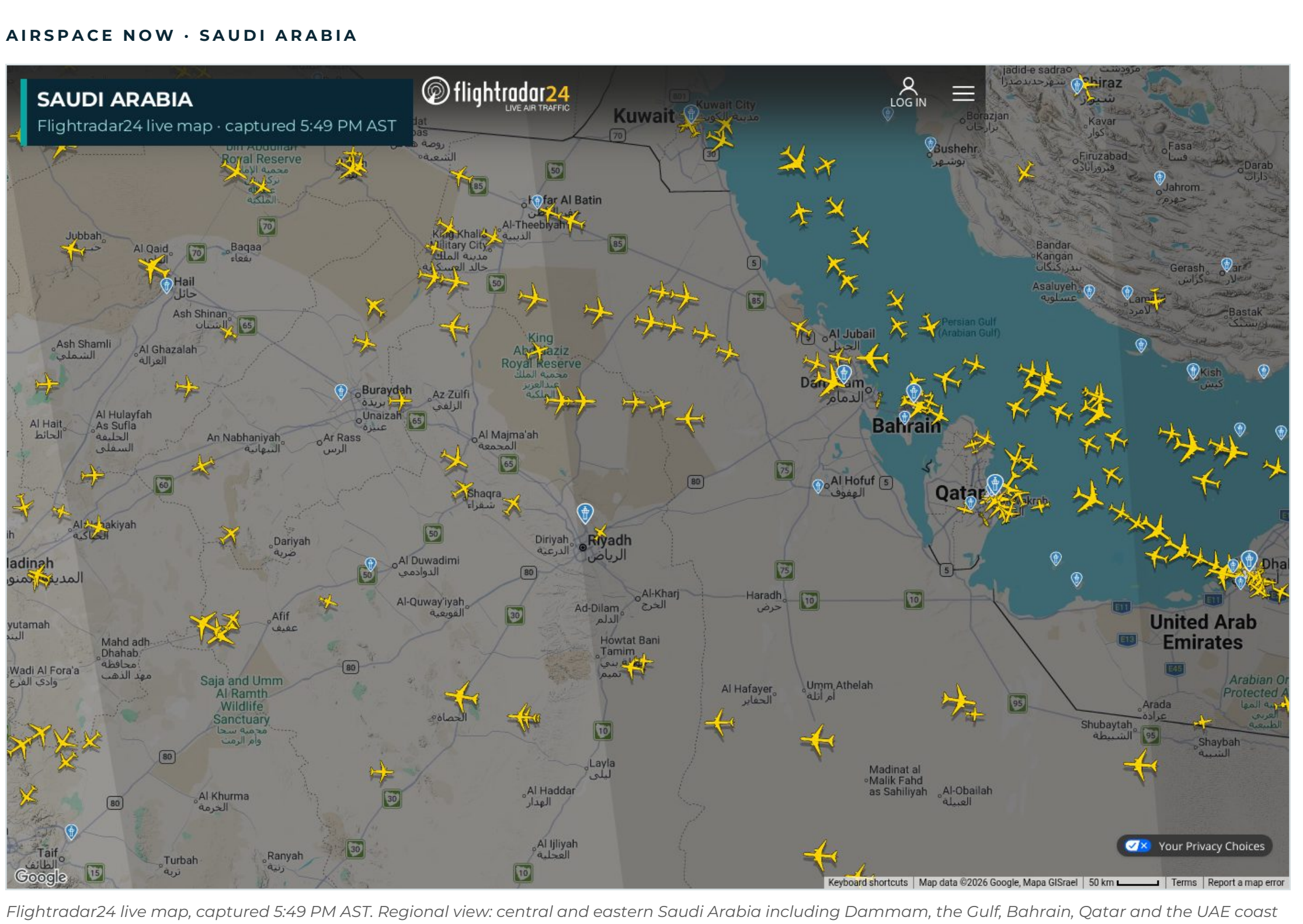
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 10:49–11:35 AM	46 min
Halt 8:17–9:18 AM	61 min
Halt 2:49–4:29 AM	100 min
Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (5:52 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA


SAUDI ARABIA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 5:49 PM AST

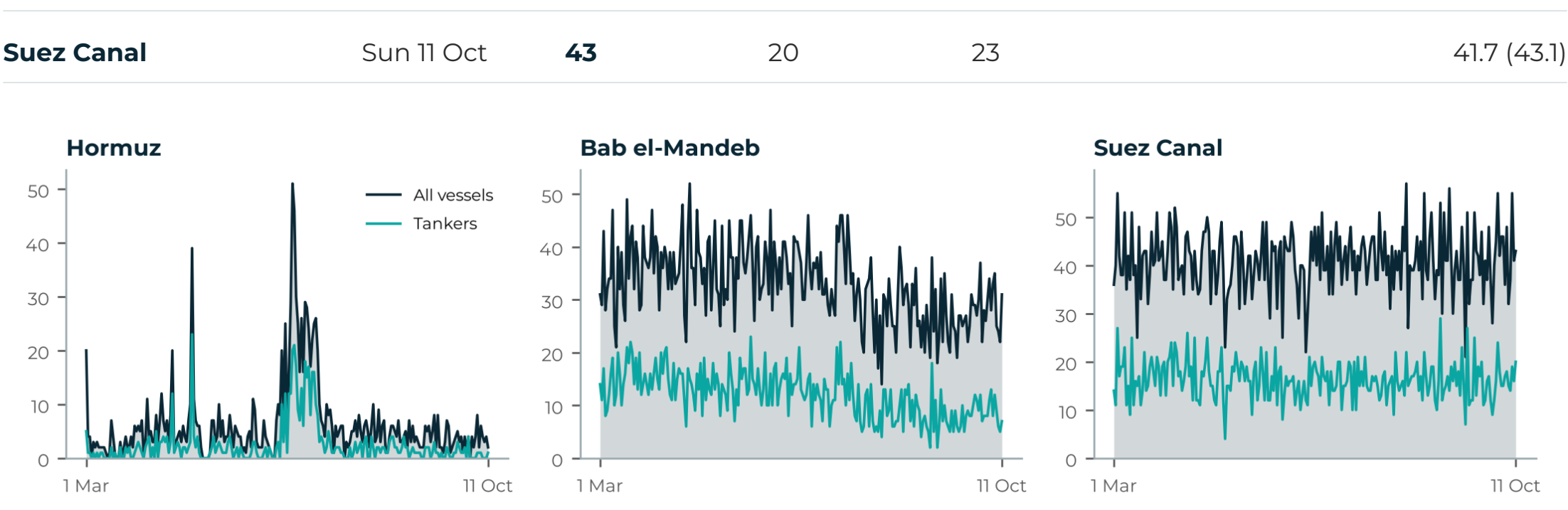
Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:49 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

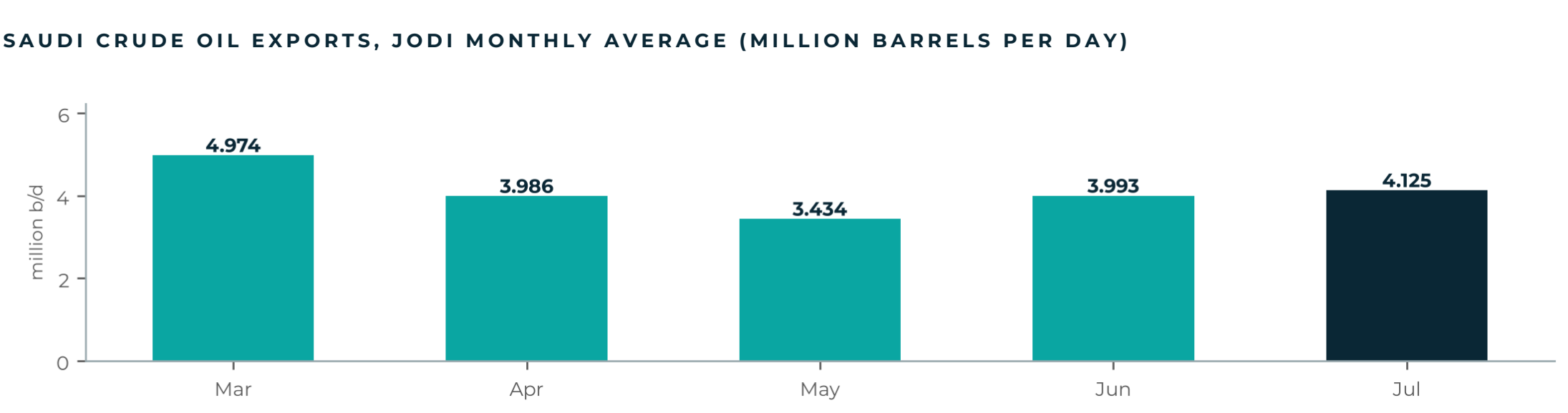
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 5:50 PM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

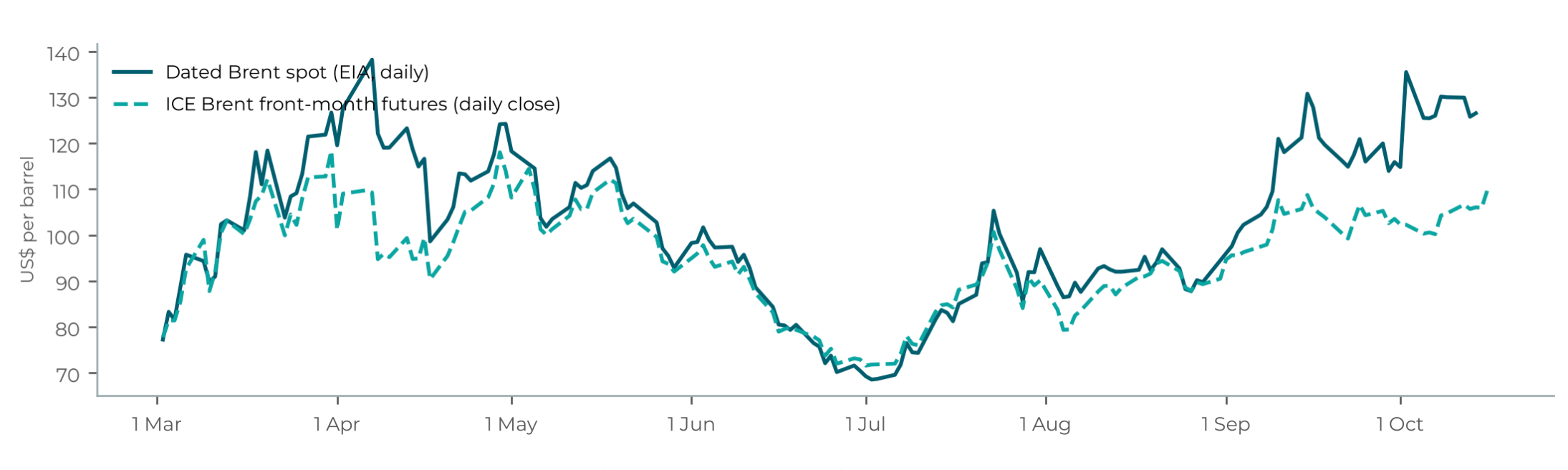


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:49 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:49 PM, Sun 18 Oct	5:49 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	7:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 7:00 PM